



Panasonic SD9 camcorder

as low as 30 seconds, depending upon the format used and the card capacity.

Digital camcorders, on the other hand, use a variety of media (flash drives, DVDs, VHS cassettes, etc) in addition to large internal memories (60 GB in some models).

This means dedicated digital camcorders can shoot much longer than digital cameras.

**Audio recording.** Both digital cameras and camcorders support audio recording. Digital cameras mostly support mono sound recording, and since these generally use a very sleek,

compact design, their microphones and speakers often cannot match the more sophisticated devices used in camcorders.

Stereo, surround sound and multichannel recording are a few among the various audio-recording options offered by dedicated digital camcorders. Also, some camcorders have manual control for audio recording.

So digital camcorders record audio better than digital cameras.

**Ergonomics.** Digital cameras are generally much smaller, sleeker and compact than digital camcorders.

**Like the movies shot by the still cameras, the stills captured by digital camcorders are not of very high quality and are therefore useful only for everyday purposes**

These are designed for easy household usage and hence the emphasis is on portability, design and ease of use.

Digital camcorders, although much smaller nowadays than their older counterparts, are still much bigger than most compact digital cameras, and handling is also not as simple, due to many features, buttons, etc. Holding the camera steady, especially during high zoom levels, is quite a problem for most users.

**Price.** Digital camcorders, with their dedicated, sophisticated video recording abilities, cost much more than most digital cameras. However, it is not logical to compare prices, as feature-to-feature comparison cannot be made between these two entirely different types of cameras.

## Why are digicams more suited for still photography?

As explained above, digital still cameras use a dedicated sensor and image processor that are designed to process digital still images. In addition, these use a built-in flash and offer various shooting modes like macro, best-shot selector, smile and blink warning to suit various shooting conditions. All this leads to results that are more-often-than-not much better than the stills captured by dedicated digital camcorders.

At many places, like museums, still shooting is allowed, but video shooting is either chargeable or prohibited. Shooting stills with a camcorder may not be allowed at many tourist spots due to regulations.

Also, for everyday purposes, the large camcorders may prove too bulky to carry around.

## Do's and don'ts for first-time buyers

### Do's

1. Do some research work before you buy either a digital still camera or a camcorder
2. Decide what is more important, shooting good-quality video or good-quality stills?
3. Check out the products you want to purchase. Handling, features and even looks are important
4. Read the manual carefully before using the product. Often you might not get satisfactory results just because you are not using the camera properly. In case of any doubt, ask for a demo from the retailer
5. Take proper care of your digital equipment. Use the necessary precautions, and always use proper recommended accessories

### Don'ts

1. Do not purchase from unauthorised dealers. You may experience malfunctions, and in some cases, the manufacturer may not be able to provide technical assistance
2. Do not use accessories that are not recommended with your product
3. Do not disassemble the camera. This might cause shock hazards, or severe damage to the product. Read the safety recommendations provided in your manual
4. Do not let small children handle the cameras without supervision
5. Do not violate safety regulations while shooting